



FAQs

60 going on 200

Q. I have a GeForce4 Ti 4400 Deluxe 128 MB graphics card on an Athlon XP 1700+ system with 256 MB DDR RAM and 40 GB hard disk on an ASUS A7V 266-EX motherboard. I have the latest nVidia and VIA 4 drivers installed. I have run many games such as *Quake III Arena* and *Return to Castle Wolfenstein*—in all of them, the frame rate is stuck at 60 fps at 1024x768 resolution. Even at lower resolutions, it hardly gets to 100 fps. The 32 MB GeForce2 MX card I had earlier was better. I have seen many of your tests where the fps is more than 200. Please tell me how to get that.

Shikhar

Via e-mail



Turn off Vertical sync for higher frame rates

A. The problem is that the card's driver is limiting the number of frames per second, based on the monitor's refresh rate. You can turn this off by opening **Control Panel > Display > Settings > Advanced > GeForce4 Ti 4400 > OpenGL Settings**. Here, look for 'Vertical sync' and change its value to 'Always off'. If this does not help, download a utility called NV Refresh Tool 2.0 (www.nvmax.com) and use it to set all refresh rates to the maximum supported.

Slow hard disk

Q. I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz system with 128 MB RDRAM. I have dual-booting operating systems, Windows 98 SE and Windows XP. When I copy data from

one drive to another while in Windows 98, it takes a lot of time as compared to the same copy operation while in XP. For example, if I copy a movie of size 1.5 GB, it takes 25 minutes in 98 and 4-5 minutes in XP. The second problem is that when I play games in 98 SE, the images jerk and sometimes the system hangs, but while in XP they work properly. Please suggest a solution.

Nitin Mishrauliya

Jodhpur

A. The hard disks could be working in PIO mode while in Windows 98. DMA mode for storage drives is enabled by default in Windows XP, but not in Windows 98. To enable DMA for your hard disk, open **Control Panel > System > Device Manager**. Double-click the hard disk under the Disk Drives branch to bring up its properties. Under the Settings tab, check the box next to DMA. On rebooting to Windows 98, you should be able to notice the difference in performance. For the same reason, games also do not respond well in Windows 98.

Bad timing

Q. I have Windows Me and Windows XP installed on different partitions. When I start the computer, its clock shows the wrong time every day. It shows 1/1/1999 and displays a message, 'CMOS checksum error'. Please tell me the cause of this error and the solution.

Vishal

Via e-mail

A. The CMOS battery seems to have died. This little battery, about the size of a 50 paise coin, is located on the motherboard itself and powers the CMOS while the mains are off. If this battery is dead, the CMOS will no longer get power and will lose all information in its memory every time the power is switched off. When this happens, the CMOS loads the default configuration from the ROM, which would have only a particular date set. All you need to do is change the battery to solve the problem. The battery (CR2032) is readily available in the market.

\Office\10.0\Common\Mailings\NewStationery

HKEY_USERS\<id>\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\HKEY_USERS\<id>\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Kernel32 if it exists

Restart the computer and delete HTT files and Kjwall.gif from C:\Windows\Web. Start Outlook Express open **Tools > Options > Compose**. In the stationery section, uncheck Mail or your own stationery

Setup problem

Q. I had created an Address Book cation in Visual Basic and using the age and Deployment Wizard, I created setup files. I tried installing the application on my office PC. It went fine till the following message appeared: 'C:\Windows\System\MSVCRT.dll. An error violation occurred while copying the file. It gave three options, viz., Abort, Retry, and Ignore. Retry didn't work, so I chose Ignore. It then gave another message, 'If you ignore a copy error, the file will not be copied. The application may not function properly as a result. Do you want to ignore the error?' On clicking Yes, the rest of the application installed successfully. It also runs correctly. Can you tell me what the above error means and how I can fix it?

Prashant Patel

Via e-mail

A. The error message is being displayed because the file is currently in use by Windows programs use shared library functions, thus reducing the number of files for each application also allowing developers to reuse functions and APIs. This is why you should always close all open programs before installing any software. Your software tried to overwrite a file while it was being used by some other application, which caused the error and your software worked perfectly because the file was already there.



Send your computer problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul 706, and we may answer it here!